

buy as well as what it would cost to sell in the future. They examined maintenance costs, taxes, insurance, and the expense of financing.

Bryce shares that as an engineer who is used to making objective decisions, “I was looking at all this stuff in terms of just numbers, and the numbers didn’t make sense.” Bryce and Kristy took emotion out of their decision, realizing they could live life with more freedom and less cost by renting instead of buying.

The rent versus buy decision is different for everyone. The key lesson from Kristy and Bryce is that math matters. The choice to own a home is one of the most important financial decisions you can make. Home ownership may make sense as a lifestyle decision, but it is rarely a good investment—unless you decide to make it a true investment as some in the FI community have.

If housing is the biggest expense most of us have under our control, it makes sense to focus on ways to start reducing expenses there. What if you could completely eliminate your housing expense? How about going a step further? What if you could turn this expense into income? Welcome to house hacking.

Todd Tresidder of the website *Financial Mentor* has lived and studied FI for decades. In response to the question, “What advice would you give someone starting out on the path to FI?” he responded: “If I